

CORPORATE TRAVEL POLICY

Global Guidelines, Authorizations, and Expense Protocols

Effective Date: January 1, 2026

Document Ref: ACME-FIN-TRV-004

Approved By: Office of the Chief Financial Officer

1. Purpose & Scope

1.1 Policy Objectives

The purpose of this Corporate Travel Policy is to establish clear and standard rules for all business-related travel at Acme Corporation. This framework is designed to ensure employee safety, optimize operational costs, and streamline expense reporting procedures. Our target is to maintain a balance between employee comfort and fiscal responsibility.

1.2 Scope and Applicability

This policy applies to all full-time and part-time employees, board members, consultants, and contractors conducting approved domestic or international business activities on behalf of Acme Corporation. All travel expenditures must conform to these regulations to be eligible for company reimbursement.

2. Travel Authorization Process

2.1 Pre-Travel Approval Requirements

All corporate travel must be formally authorized prior to reserving any transportation or accommodation options. Domestic travel requires written confirmation from the immediate Department Head. International travel requires approval from the corresponding Divisional Executive VP at least 21 days before departure.

Notice: Expenses incurred for non-approved travel or travel booked outside official platforms will be considered personal liabilities and will not be reimbursed by the company.

2.2 Corporate Booking Channels

All travel arrangements must be completed through the corporate enterprise portal (AcmeTravel Online) or our authorized Travel Management Partner (TMP). Utilizing third-party consumer booking systems is prohibited unless written authorization is granted by the Finance team due to logistical constraints.

3. Transportation Guidelines

3.1 Air Travel Classifications

Air travel bookings should favor practical, cost-effective options, utilizing advanced scheduling discounts wherever possible.

Flight Duration	Authorized Cabin Class	Exceptions & Notes
Under 6 Continuous Hours	Economy Class (Standard)	Includes all domestic regional flights.
6 to 10 Continuous Hours	Premium Economy	Requires VP approval for Business Class upgrades.
Over 10 Continuous Hours	Business Class	Applicable to transcontinental long-haul itineraries.

3.2 Rail and Ground Infrastructure

For destinations under 300 miles, rail travel is highly recommended. Standard coach or business class seating is fully authorized. For local ground travel, employees should prefer public transit or approved rideshare options. Personal vehicle use will be reimbursed at standard corporate mileage rates.

4. Lodging & Accommodations

4.1 Hotel Category Limits

Employees are expected to stay in standard business hotels. The maximum allowable room rates (excluding local taxes) are managed based on destination tiering indexes:

- **Tier 1 Cities (e.g., New York, London, Tokyo):** Up to \$350 per night.
- **Tier 2 Cities (e.g., Chicago, Berlin, Sydney):** Up to \$220 per night.
- **Tier 3 Cities (All other destinations):** Up to \$150 per night.

4.2 Incidental Charges and Upgrades

Room service charges, in-room mini-bar items, spa services, and video entertainment purchases are considered personal expenses and will not be covered by corporate funds. Standard internet connectivity fees are fully reimbursable if required for professional activities.

5. Meals & Incidentals (M&IE)

5.1 Daily Per Diem Structures

Acme Corporation utilizes a standard per diem system to cover meal costs and incidental elements during travel status. These daily allocations cover breakfast, lunch, dinner, and gratuities:

- Domestic Standard Rate: \$75.00 per diem
- International Premium Rate: \$110.00 per diem

5.2 Business Entertainment Contexts

When an employee hosts a business dinner with clients, the per diem structure is paused. These hospitality expenses should be filed separately under Entertainment Expenses, and documentation must include an itemized receipt along with a list of all attendees and their organizations.

6. Expense Reporting & Reimbursement

6.1 Submission Timelines

All expense claims must be uploaded to the corporate reconciliation platform within 14 calendar days after returning from a trip. Claims filed beyond 45 days will require review and approval from the Chief Financial Officer.

6.2 Required Receipt Documentation

Itemized digital receipts must be attached for any single transaction exceeding \$25.00. Credit card statements alone are not accepted as valid proof of purchase for lodging, transportation, or client entertainment events.

7. Safety, Security, & Traveler Health

7.1 Emergency Support Infrastructure

Acme Corporation partners with a global security risk consultancy to support our team members worldwide. Before traveling internationally, employees must download the corporate emergency application onto their mobile devices to receive real-time security updates and access 24/7 medical assistance lines.

7.2 Travel Insurance Coverages

The company maintains broad insurance plans covering emergency medical evacuation, lost luggage protection, and trip cancellation costs for employees on active business travel status. Specific coverage summaries can be requested through the Risk Management division.

8. Compliance & Policy Enforcement

8.1 Auditing Frameworks

The Internal Audit team conducts monthly random reviews of corporate travel claims to verify compliance with this policy. Intentional inflation of costs or falsification of receipts will result in immediate disciplinary action.

8.2 Exception Authorization Pathways

Any variance from the rules defined in this policy must be documented and approved in writing by the CFO before travel occurs. Approved exceptions must be attached to the final expense report.